Inbound

The KYC-verified commerce layer for every inbound traveler.

60 seconds from passport to full participation in any country's digital economy. Starting with the hardest market.

Seed Round · $2M

Raising with strategic seed investors in deep tech and data infrastructure.

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01 · THE PATTERN

Every decade, one company makes cross-border connection trivial.

Inbound is building that company for the 1.5B annual cross-border travelers — currently locked out of the local digital economy they visit.

2011

Zoom

BEFORE

Conference room hardware, $5k/seat, IT-managed

AFTER

One URL. One click. Anyone joins.

2015

Stripe

BEFORE

Merchant account, 90-day approval, legal review

AFTER

Seven lines of code. Accept payments globally.

2026

Inbound

BEFORE

Foreign SIM, VPN, cash, broken wallet setup, 40-minute activation

AFTER

Scan passport. Walk out with a fully-configured device. 60 seconds.

150M foreigners entered China in 2025. Most can't pay for coffee.

The same wall exists in Japan, Thailand, India, Saudi Arabia. China is just the hardest version — the market where software-only solutions have failed most completely. Solve it here, and the template ports.

Why foreigners hit a wall

- **No local number**
  eSIM doesn't support foreign passports. Every Chinese app requires a local number to register.
- **Payment apps can't onboard**
  WeChat Pay binding fails 60%+ of the time for foreign cards. Alipay Tour Pass caps at $5K/year.
- **Internet is siloed**
  Google, Meta, WhatsApp blocked. VPN is illegal for commercial providers to offer.
- **No KYC bridge**
  A foreigner's identity in the US cannot be verified by a Chinese service provider in real-time.

THE BLOCKED MARKET

$130B

spent by foreign visitors in China, 2025

$11B

via mobile payment — 8.5% capture

The other $119B moves through cash, broken card swipes, and skipped purchases.

Every pure-software attempt has failed the last mile.

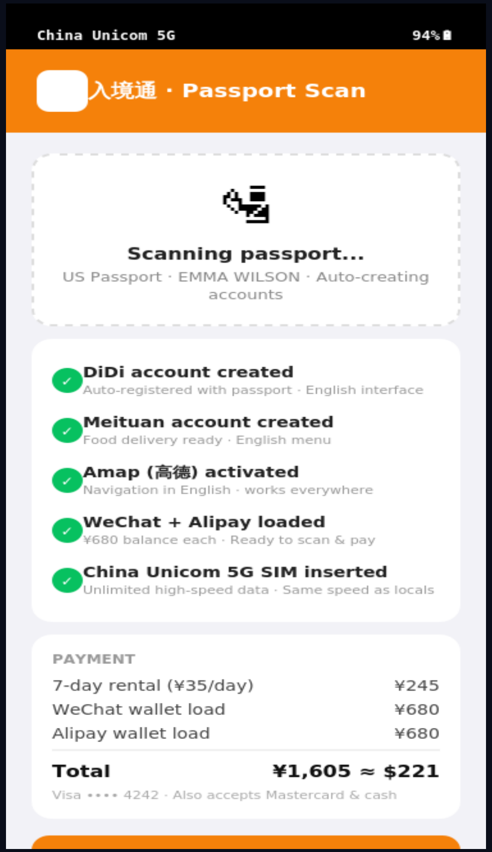
Not for lack of trying. The gaps are structural — identity, SIM issuance, and payment are regulated layers a pure-software product can't traverse.

Approach	What it solves	What it can't solve	Why
International eSIM	Data connectivity	Can't register for any Chinese app; no local number	Regulatory
Alipay Tour Pass	Basic QR payments	$5K/year cap; no WeChat Pay; no local services access	AML / KYC
VPN apps	Home-country internet	Illegal for commercial providers; constantly blocked	Legal
Translation apps	Language friction	Don't solve identity, payment, or access layer	Surface-only
WiFi egg / pocket router	Group data sharing	Doesn't solve any account or payment problem	Wrong layer
Inbound (hardware-anchored)	**All of the above + KYC bridge**	**—**	**Regulated hardware is the key**

The insight: every point solution above stops at a regulated choke-point (SIM, KYC, payment rails, network access). A **pre-configured physical device** is the smallest possible physical artifact that clears all four choke-points simultaneously. Hardware is the wedge — not the product.

60 seconds from passport to full digital participation.

At baggage claim: scan, tap, go. Every local account pre-authenticated. Wallet pre-funded. Data, maps, translation, international internet — all working before the traveler leaves the airport.



Onboarding at airport kiosk

01 **Identity & KYC bridge**

Passport OCR + liveness check + visa verification, cleared against carrier & payment AML requirements in a single flow

02 **Pre-funded payment layer**

WeChat Pay & Alipay wallets loaded at kiosk via traveler's existing foreign card — 100% payment success from step one

03 **Local super-apps, pre-authenticated**

DiDi, Meituan, Amap, Trip all registered to the traveler's passport identity. No 'verification code to China mobile number' dead-ends

04 **Compliant international connectivity**

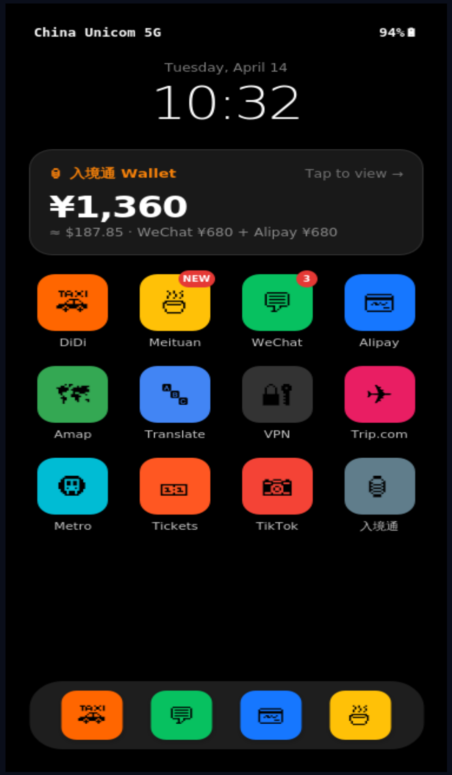
Dual-SIM with offshore roaming carrier for international services — no VPN, compliant with PRC telecom law

05 **Cryptographic wipe on return**

GDPR/PIPL-grade remote factory reset on device return, logged and auditable. Privacy is a product feature, not an afterthought

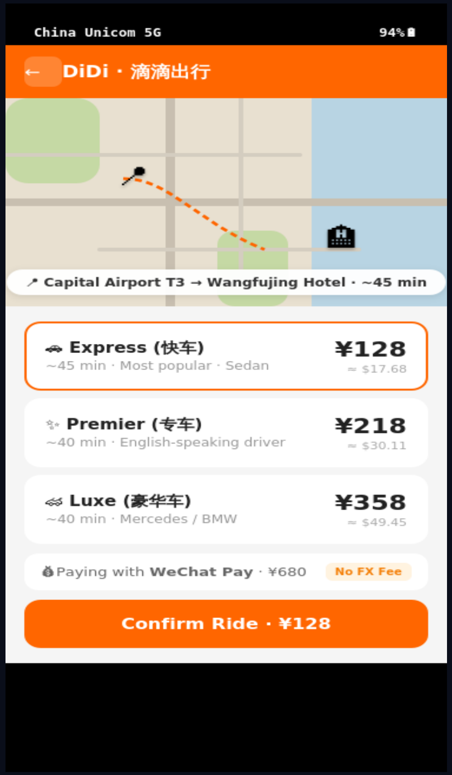
What a traveler actually sees.

Live interactive prototype available on request. Representative screens below trace a 7-day trip.



T+60 sec

Home screen. 12 local apps pre-signed-in. Wallet ¥1,360 funded.

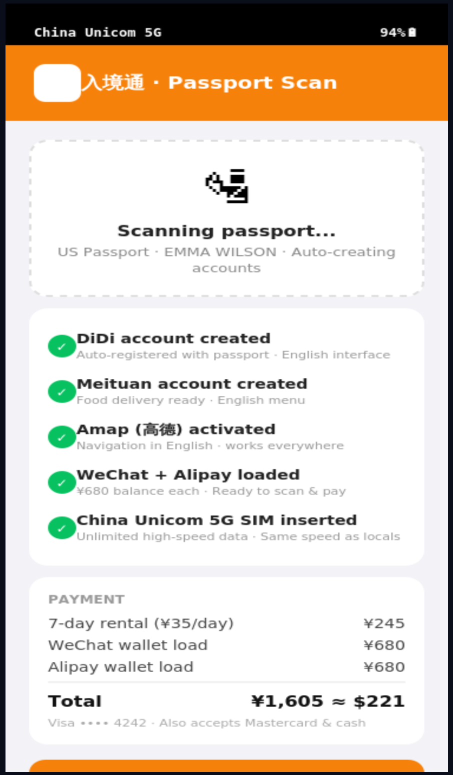


T+5 min

First DiDi ride. English UI. WeChat Pay auto-debit.

T+2 hr

WeChat with hotel concierge. Real-time EN ↔ CN translation.



T+7 days

Kiosk return. Wallet balance refunded. Device remotely wiped.

Hardware rental is the wedge. The data is the company.

Every device generates a stream of KYC-verified, consent-based, cross-border commerce data — a dataset that neither Alibaba nor Tencent can assemble from their existing products.

The proprietary data asset

Identity layer

Nationality, age, travel purpose, visa type

Spend layer

Categorized transactions across 10+ Chinese rails

Movement layer

City flow, dwell time, return frequency

Preference layer

App usage, merchant selection, language switches

WHY THIS DATA IS UNIQUE

A foreigner's China trip is the only consumer event on earth that generates identity, payment, and cross-cultural preference data in a single session.

Tencent sees spend, no identity.
Alibaba sees spend, no cross-country signal.
Booking/Trip sees travel intent, no real spend.

Inbound sees all three, by construction.

What 'hardware-anchored' actually means in engineering.

The product looks like a rental. The engineering is a KYC-bridging orchestration platform. Five proprietary systems, none of which off-the-shelf vendors solve together.

A

Passport-to-Account Orchestrator

Single 60-second flow chains 8+ external services (carrier, WeChat, Alipay, DiDi, Meituan, Trip, etc.) with retry/fallback logic. Proprietary.

B

Cross-border KYC Verifier

Passport OCR + NFC read + liveness + visa check, against both payment AML rules and PRC telecom real-name rules, in one pass.

C

Payment Routing Engine

Foreign card → licensed FX provider → RMB wallet top-up. Handles Visa/MC/Mir/UnionPay/cash with graceful degradation. Per-transaction routing.

D

Device Posture & Remote Wipe

MDM layer with geofence, jailbreak detection, 10-min heartbeats, cryptographically verifiable wipe-on-return with audit log.

E

Event Stream → Data Warehouse

All traveler activity (with consent) flows to a structured warehouse. Feeds Slide 06 moat from day one.

China first. Then every inbound-tourism market on earth.

China is our beachhead because it's the hardest version of the problem. The infrastructure we build in China compounds across 15+ high-volume inbound markets.

150M	1.5B	$1.9T	<10%
China inbound, 2025	global inbound trips	global travel spending	digitally captured
Our beachhead market	UNWTO 2024 · cross-border arrivals	Our expanded TAM	The opportunity, globally

Why this is buildable in 2026 — and replicable after

BEACHHEAD

China regulatory opening

PBOC raised foreigner wallet caps 5x in 2024. 79 visa-free countries (up from 15). PIPL cert path live Jan 2026 — a compliance wall for anyone coming later, a moat for the first compliant player.

TEMPLATE

Same problem, every market

Japan, Thailand, India, Saudi Arabia, Indonesia all run their own closed-loop domestic payment/identity stacks. The same KYC-bridge + hardware-anchor architecture ports with localization, not rebuild.

TIMING

Global travel back to +5% YoY

UNWTO 2024: international arrivals fully recovered to pre-pandemic levels. 1.5B annual trips growing. No incumbent has solved the payment/identity handshake at the border — the window is still open.

Rentals get us to cash flow. Commerce gets us to venture scale.

Year 1: validate unit economics on rentals. Year 3: take a cut of every dollar a foreigner spends through the Inbound rail.

Three revenue horizons

H1 · Year 1–2 **Device rental**	\$20/day × 7 days × 70% util	**65%**
H2 · Year 2–3 **Platform take rate**	2–5% on ~\$2,000 spend per traveler	**80%**
H3 · Year 3+ **Data & API**	B2B licensing to OTAs, duty-free, luxury retail, telcos	**90%+**

UNIT MATH PER TRAVELER

Rental revenue (7 days)	\$140
Device + SIM + ops cost	-\$50
H1 gross profit	**\$90**
H2 · Est. GMV through Inbound	\$2,000
H2 · Take-rate @ 3%	\$60
Blended per-trip gross	**\$150**

Three moats that compound. 12-month path to Series A.

Regulatory licensing, airport placement, and proprietary data — all accumulated advantages that strengthen over time rather than erode.

Regulatory

Telecom real-name partnership, licensed FX processor, PIPL data processor certification. 12–18 months to replicate — minimum.

Physical placement

Exclusive airport kiosk deals at flagship gateways. Real estate, not just software — not subject to download / update cycle.

Data compounding

Every traveler strengthens the recommendation and fraud models. Data licensing revenue starts in Year 2, accelerates forever.

12-month plan with this seed round

1 Q1–Q2 '26

China pilot — 1 gateway

150 devices · 1,000 travelers · unit econ validated

2 Q3 '26

Payment & KYC infra live

Orchestrator + routing in production

3 Q4 '26

2nd airport · Series A prep

5,000+ travelers · data warehouse emitting

4 H1 '27

Series A → 2nd market

Thailand or Japan · replay the China playbook

Raising $2M seed to build the rails.

Co-lead-friendly. Open to seed funds with conviction in infrastructure-layer bets.

USE OF FUNDS

40% — **Engineering build-out**
Orchestrator, KYC, payment routing, MDM, data pipeline

25% — **Pilot fleet & kiosk**
300 devices + 2 airport kiosks + field ops

20% — **Regulatory & compliance**
Carrier partnership, FX license, PIPL processor cert

15% — **Key hires**
Technical co-founder, compliance lead, airport BD

TEAM

Technical founding team, currently expanding.

Led by an experienced technical founder with prior company-building experience. Deep engineering background, bilingual operating capacity across North America and Asia. Key compliance, airport-BD, and growth roles actively being filled with this round.

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Product demo, full data room, and traction updates available on request.